

RAEF KHAN

Northwestern University Department of Linguistics
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Last updated: May 2026

EDUCATION

Northwestern University

Ph.D., Linguistics

Sept 2022 - (Expected) July 2027

Evanston, IL

Northwestern University

M.A., Linguistics

Sept 2022 - March 2025

Evanston, IL

Thesis: Do You Have Extreme Pain?: The Effect of Sociolinguistic Variation on Patient Outcomes

Committee: Annette D'Onofrio, Eszter Ronai

New York University

B.A., Linguistics and Computer Science

Sept 2018 - May 2022

New York, NY

magna cum laude, with Honors in Linguistics. GPA: 3.91/4

Honors Thesis: Is Your Speech Prestigious?: Understanding Prestige Bias in Google's Dialectal Arabic Voice Assistants

Committee: Laurel MacKenzie, Gregory Guy

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Sociolinguistics; (Socio-)Pragmatics; Language Discrimination and Bias; Computational Linguistics; Health Disparities; Social Determinants of Health

PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 **Khan, R.**, D'Onofrio, A. (2025). How "Extreme" is Extreme Pain?: Patient Identity and Intensifier Usage Affects Physicians' Perceptions of Pain. Poster presentation at *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 53 (NWAV53)*, University of Michigan, 5-7 November, Ann Arbor, MI.
- 2025 **Khan, R.**, D'Onofrio, A. (2025). Who's in Extreme Pain?: Social Information Modulates Intensifier Interpretation. Poster presentation at the *11th Experimental Pragmatics Conference (XPRAG 2025)*, University of Cambridge, 17-19 September, Cambridge, United Kingdom.
- 2025 **Khan, R.**, D'Onofrio, A. (2025). The Effect of Identity and Language Choice on Physicians' Perceptions of Pain. Poster presentation at the American Medical Association *ChangeMedEd® 2025*, Swissôtel Chicago, 11-13 September, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 **Khan, R.**, D'Onofrio, A. (2025). Who's in Extreme Pain?: The Effect of Identity and Intensifiers on Physicians' Perceptions of Pain. Oral presentation at the 61st Annual Meeting of the *Chicago Linguistic Society (CLS61)*, University of Chicago, 9-11 May, Chicago, IL.
- 2024 **Khan, R.** (2024). Do You Have Any Pain?: The Effect of Sociolinguistic Variation on Patient Outcomes. Oral presentation at *Linguistics QP Fest 2024*, Northwestern University, 31 May, Evanston, IL.
- 2023 **Khan, R.** (2023). Do You Have Any Pain?: Linguistic and Social Variables' Impact on Doctor Perceptions and Treatments. Poster presentation at *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 51 (NWAV51)*, Queens College/CUNY, 13-15 October, Queens, NY.
- 2022 **Khan, R.** (2022). Is Your Speech Prestigious? Understanding Prestige Bias in Google's Dialectal Arabic Voice Assistants. Poster presentation at the 48th *Undergraduate Research Conference*, New York University, 6 May, New York, NY.

INVITED TALKS

- 2026 (scheduled) **Khan, R.** (2026). Whose Pain is *Actually* Extreme?: The Effect of Identity and Intensifiers on Physicians' Perceptions of Pain. *Gender Lunch Seminars and CRESA WIP*, Università Vita-Salute San Raffaele, 13 May.
- 2026 **Khan, R.** (2026). Who's in Extreme Pain?: The Effect of Identity and Intensifiers on Physicians' Perceptions of Pain. *LING-890: Seminar in Meaning*, University of Delaware, 8 April.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Primary Instructor <i>Northwestern University</i>	<i>Sept 2025 - Present</i>
LING-482: Individual Speech and Language Instruction for Nonnative Speakers of English	<i>Spring 2026</i>
LING-482: Individual Speech and Language Instruction for Nonnative Speakers of English	<i>Winter 2026</i>
LING-482: Individual Speech and Language Instruction for Nonnative Speakers of English	<i>Fall 2025</i>
Teaching Assistant <i>Northwestern University</i>	<i>Apr 2024 - July 2025</i>
LING-480: American Academic Culture for Non-Native speakers of English (with T. Wysocki)	<i>Summer 2025</i>
Guest Lecture: Outlines	
LING-220: Language and Society (with A. D'Onofrio)	<i>Spring 2025</i>
Guest Lecture: Language Ideologies & Linguistic Subordination	
LING-223/GNDR-ST-234: Language and Gender (with G. Ward)	<i>Winter 2025</i>
Guest Lecture: Gendered Talk Online	
LING-270: Meaning (with B. Clark)	<i>Spring 2024</i>
Linguistics Summer Workshop: Introduction to L^AT_EX <i>Northwestern University</i>	<i>July 5, 2023</i>

GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Cognitive Science Travel Grant <i>Northwestern University Cognitive Science</i>	<i>Summer 2025</i> \$500
Linguistics Travel Grant <i>Northwestern University Department of Linguistics</i>	<i>Summer 2025</i> \$450
Graduate Research Grant <i>Northwestern University Department of Linguistics</i>	<i>March 2024</i> \$500
Conference Travel Grant <i>Northwestern University</i>	<i>Fall 2023</i> \$800
Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund <i>New York University</i>	<i>Fall 2021</i> \$913
Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund <i>New York University</i>	<i>Spring 2021</i> \$125
Dean's Undergraduate Research Fund <i>New York University</i>	<i>Fall 2020</i> \$800
Gilman Scholarship <i>New York University</i>	<i>Fall 2019</i> \$5,000

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Accent Bias Working Group <i>Bilingualism Matters Chicago</i>	<i>Sept 2024 - Present</i>
Climate Committee Member <i>Northwestern University Department of Linguistics</i>	<i>Sept 2024 - June 2025, April 2026 - Present</i>
Colloquium Speaker Series Committee Member <i>Northwestern University Department of Linguistics</i>	<i>May 2025 - Present</i>
Colloquium Speaker Series Graduate Assistant <i>Northwestern University Department of Linguistics</i>	<i>May 2023 - June 2024</i>
Colloquium Reception Committee Member <i>Northwestern University Department of Linguistics</i>	<i>Sept 2022 - June 2023</i>
Linguistics Summer Workshop Coordinator <i>Northwestern University Department of Linguistics</i>	<i>June 2023 - July 2023</i>
Student Volunteer <i>NWAV 47 at New York University</i>	<i>Oct 18-21, 2018</i>

HONORS AND AWARDS

Phi Beta Kappa	<i>May 2022</i>
Presidential Honors Scholar Program <i>New York University</i>	<i>Sept 2018 - May 2022</i>

SKILLS

Languages: English (Native), Arabic (Heritage, Hijazi Dialect), Urdu (Heritage Receptive), German (Beginner), Japanese (Beginner)

Statistics: Python, R, L^AT_EX, Data Visualization (ggplot2), Data Analysis (tidyverse), Ordinal Regression

Interpersonal: Collaboration, adaptability, communication, detail-oriented

REFERENCES

References available upon request